

SANGJUN (SAMUEL) Ko

1025 Lucerne Drive, Menasha, Wisconsin, 54952 | samuelkocho.sk@gmail.com |
www.linkedin.com/in/sangjunko

EDUCATION

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign
Bachelor of Science in Statistics (CGPA: 3.93/4.00)

- Mathematics Minor

Champaign, Illinois
January 2023 - May 2025

WORK EXPERIENCE

Advantage xPO (on assignment at Kimberly-Clark)
Statistician

Neenah, Wisconsin
June 2025 - Present

- Automate and standardize high-throughput lab-study reporting in R/JMP, reducing per-report cycle time from 3 hours to 20 minutes (90%) and supporting 8–10 reports/month
- Deliver statistical decision support for 15–20 studies/month, using mixed models/ANOVA, multiple comparisons, and clear summaries for R&D stakeholders
- Develop Excel/VBA self-serve workflows for instrument-imaging-derived data, enabling 20+ stakeholders to run standardized analyses and cutting turnaround from 2 days to minutes
- Execute measurement system and method studies (e.g., Gage R&R, equivalency/validation, spec-limit proposals) and translate results into practical recommendations, assumptions, and next steps

STAT107 Data Science Discovery
Undergraduate Course Assistant

Champaign, Illinois
August 2023 - May 2025

- Assisted over 300 students with fundamental data science concepts through interactive labs
- Managed Git for learning platform modifications, benefiting 1000+ students; create, edit, and proofread course materials

Applied Technologies for Learning in Arts & Sciences
AI/ML Intern Team Leader

Champaign, Illinois
January 2024 - December 2024

- Lead a team of 5 interns and collaborated closely with 3 managers in weekly meetings
- Built ML models with 100,000+ data points using Python and advanced techniques like XGBoost and BERT

PROJECTS/AWARDS

Graduation Prediction Model

September 2024 - December 2024

- Increased AUC score from 0.65 to 0.82 by reducing noise in the dataset through feature engineering and outlier removal across 50,000+ student records
- Built a Streamlit interface with 12 key predictors for real-time predictions for university administrators

3rd Place, 2024 CIC Student Paper Challenge (Columbia University)

September 2024

- Analyzed the socioeconomic and mental health impacts of COVID-19 in Mexico, identifying that 42% of females and 40% of young adults faced job loss
- Proposed interventions to support vulnerable groups through geospatial and statistical analysis

Paraphrase Detection

July 2024

- Achieved 90%+ accuracy in paraphrase detection using BERT, RoBERTa, and SBERT models on the MRPC dataset
- Developed a Gradio interface for real-time detection for easier evaluation of textual similarities

SKILLS

Languages: English (Fluent), Spanish (Native), Korean (Native), French (Basic), Chinese (Basic)
Computer: Python (Advanced): Pandas, NumPy, Scikit-learn, TensorFlow, NLTK, Matplotlib
R (Intermediate): Tidyverse, ggplot2, dplyr, caret
JMP (Intermediate), Excel/VBA (Intermediate), Git (Intermediate), SAS (Intermediate)
SQL (Basic), Tableau (Basic), Office (Advanced)
Certificates: Data Science Certificate, Coursera Business Analytics Certificate

COMMUNITY SERVICE AND EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

Volunteer, Appleton Public Library

August 2025 - Present

- Support shelving/organization and “Game On” programs by guiding participants to games/activities and assisting with setup during sessions

Consultant in Illinois Business Consulting

September 2024 - December 2024

- Collaborating with interdisciplinary teams to deliver strategic solutions for real-world business challenges, including market analysis, operational optimization, and growth strategy, for clients ranging from Fortune 100 companies to nonprofits